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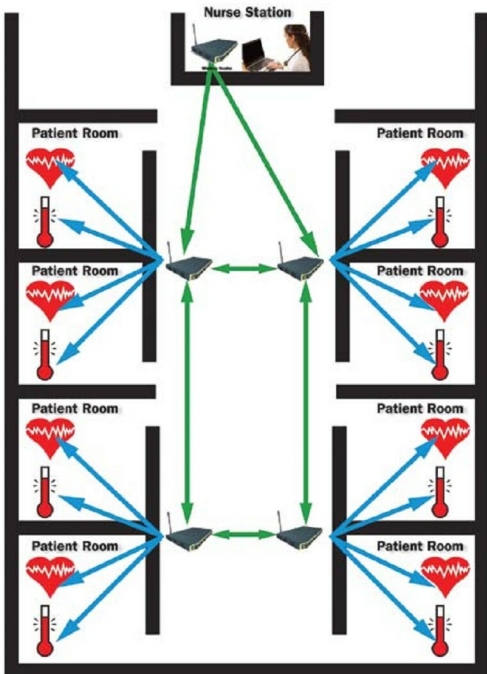


Fig. 3: Hypothetical nursing home application using IEEE 802.15.4, where temperature and heart rate are monitored in each patient's room. With this topology, patients are free to move about the facility and connect to any of the routers. The blue lines are join lines for end devices. The green lines are communication paths for routers back to the coordinator

Fig. 3 shows a typical medical application of IEEE 802.15.4.

Benefits accrued

As the cost per node for IEEE 802.11 and IEEE 802.15.4 transceivers decreases and the power consumption is lowered to a more appropriate level for embedded systems, the viability of implementing wireless networks for patient monitoring and asset tracking in hospitals and other medical environments becomes more apparent.

In addition to lower cost, healthcare providers can provide better tracking and access to readings, more efficient use of resources and faster response to critical needs.

So when looking at your next design, consider using any of these wireless technologies to communicate to the outside world. ●

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